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TEACHING STATEMENT

My teaching philosophy is shaped by my deep curiosity about how we, humans, learn and understand complex ideas and theories. Having spent much of my life as a student or an instructor, I see learning as a continuous and evolving process, requiring repeated engagement and practical application to foster deep understanding. This belief drives my teaching approach of creating an engaging learning environment and ensuring students grasp and retain key concepts long after the course ends.

Approach to Teaching

My approach to teaching centers around sparking curiosity among students and making complex ideas relatable through real-world examples. In my Principles of Microeconomics course at Clemson University, I begin the first lecture by asking students to weigh the trade-offs of being in class versus doing anything else with their time. This introduction to opportunity costs and scarcity frames the relevance of economics in their daily lives from the very first day. Similarly, in my Statistics for Business and Economics course at East West University in Dhaka, I challenged students with the Monty Hall problem, encouraging them to work in groups to solve it and articulate their reasoning. These methods not only introduce core concepts but also build an atmosphere of active participation and collaboration. Moreover, I make a concerted effort to encourage participation from all students. I firmly believe learning should be a positive and enjoyable experience and I strive to make every student feel heard and supported in class. Integrating group work and class discussions ensures students can learn from each other and develop a stronger grasp of the material.

Teaching Experience

1. Principles of Microeconomics (Introductory)
2. Mathematics for Business and Economics I (Introductory)
3. Introduction to Statistics (Introductory)
4. Statistics for Business and Economics (Upper-level)

Philosophy behind Course Design

I designed the course materials for each of the above courses. My primary aim when designing courses is to focus on the learning experience of the students. I believe each student will be enrolling in my courses with their unique background and my focus is to disseminate new knowledge by building upon their prior knowledge and experiences through active engagement. I prioritize opportunities for students to discover, critique, apply ideas and be guided throughout the course in a predictable manner. Hence, I make sure that the goals and tentative timeline for each courses are clearly stated in the syllabus and students can learn and enhance their reasoning skills through problem-based learning, inquired based activities

and collaborative group work.

Pedagogical Methods

My teaching combines theory with practical, relatable examples. For instance, I introduce supply and demand by having students design a pricing system for college football tickets based on the visiting team; this exercise makes an abstract economic principle tangible. For market power and markups, I use live examples from the Amazon website to illustrate how branded and generic products are priced differently. These examples ground theoretical concepts in familiar experiences, helping students connect the coursework with the world around them.

I also prioritize structured, iterative learning implemented through regular quizzes, assignments, and exams. In-class group activities encourage collaborative problem-solving and let students make mistakes without pressure. Weekly take-home quizzes offer multiple attempts to arrive at the correct answer, fostering a growth mindset. We thoroughly discuss the weekly quiz answers in class, letting students learn from their errors and solidify their understanding. Exams are evenly spaced throughout the semester, providing consistent opportunities to measure and reflect on their progress.

Future Goals and Commitment to Teaching

My goal as an instructor is to learn from past teaching experiences and thrive to teach better on the next iteration of the course. Looking ahead, I plan to further refine my teaching methods by incorporating interactive platforms such as Large Language Models (Gemini, Claude or ChatGPT) to engage students inside the classroom. I also plan to continue developing courses that emphasize practical applications of economic theories with statistical tools, ensuring students learn how to apply them in real-world contexts. More specifically, I want to design and teach courses that introduces students to programming languages such as Python and R and have them replicate results from already published datasets from reputable journals. I am also eager to introduce my research on financial accessibility of underserved communities and community banking into the classroom and plan to involve undergraduate students in ongoing research projects and encourage them to develop and pursue their own research interests. In conclusion, I remain committed to fostering a learning environment that values diversity, encourages critical thinking and personal growth, and makes learning a rewarding experience for every student.

Further materials

Detailed syllabi and slides for these courses are available on my website, and course evaluations are available upon request. The next sections provide a brief summary of my teaching evaluations from Summer 2023 and Fall 2023 respectively.

Student feedback from the Principles of Microeconomics

- The instructor was extremely patient with our learning. She would make sure that we understood what was going on at all times before she moved on. She also would answer questions with thorough explanation and she was overall so very helpful and wonderful at teaching microeconomics.
- Overall, my professor did a good job at explaining concepts and showing us exactly what we needed to learn.
- I liked the in-class quizzes because they helped me a lot on the test.
- The assessment practices in this course are very helpful because there are multiple quizzes a week that do not impact your grade but allow you to see how well you know the material.
- I enjoyed this course overall.
- The course was conducted in a friendly, non stressful manner, which reduces anxiety by upcoming assessments. Moreover, her use of assessment review after the assessments proves crucial when studying for future assessments and at least helped me succeed in the class.
- I knew what was I expected to understand going into every assignment and was always tested on things we went over.
- Instructor was very helpful in making sure each student understood the concepts, and did not hesitate to go over material multiple times.
- I believe that the in class quizzes my professor would to give every Friday gave me and my classmates a much better understanding of our course material.
- Professor Razzak always gave clear instructions on what was expected of her students and what needed to be focused on in order to receive the best grades.
- She was very good at explaining the graphs by drawing them out and would not give up teaching them until the majority of the class understood, she also provided very helpful feedback on all of our quizzes and exams.

Selected Raw Scores

Prompt	My Score	Department Score
The learning outcomes in the course were clearly communicated.	4.33	4.46
The course assignments were related to the course learning outcomes	4.67	4.55
I understood what was expected of me in this course.	4.75	4.49
The instructor encouraged questioning and discussion of course topics from the students.	4.17	4.27
The course challenged me to think critically and communicate clearly about the subject.	4.50	4.37

Table 1: Summer 2023

Prompt	My Score	Department Score
The learning outcomes in the course were clearly communicated.	4.14	4.28
The course assignments were related to the course learning outcomes	4	4.41
I understood what was expected of me in this course.	3.86	4.34
The instructor encouraged questioning and discussion of course topics from the students.	3.86	4.35
The course challenged me to think critically and communicate clearly about the subject.	4.19	4.32

Table 2: Fall 2023